

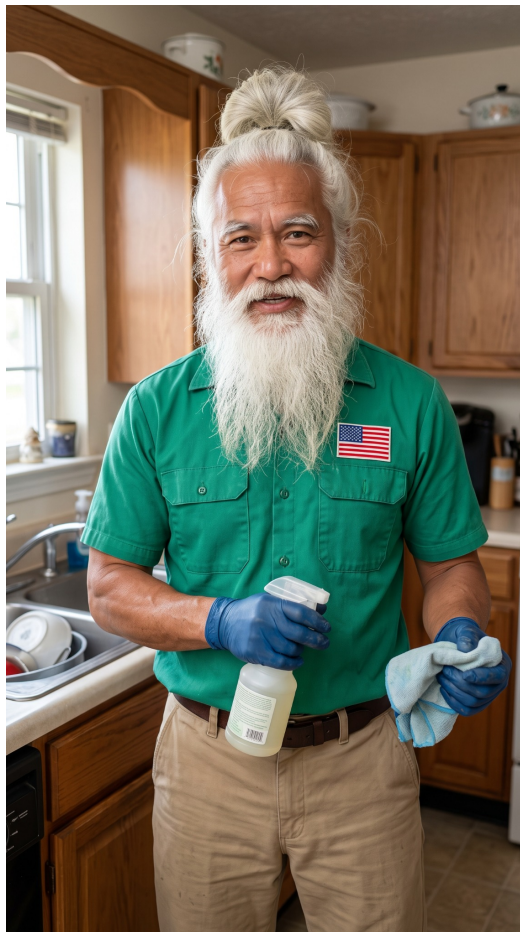
PRACTICAL HOME CARE

THE HOME RESCUE BOOK

50 Practical Solutions for
Everyday Problems That Happen at Home

**Cleaning • Stains • Odors • Kitchen
Bathroom • Laundry • Home Care**

Simple methods. Practical fixes. Less guesswork.



A PRACTICAL REFERENCE GUIDE

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

You do not need to read this book from beginning to end. Think of it as a home reference guide: find the problem, check what you need, follow the steps, and move on with your day.

THE SIMPLE FORMULA

1. Identify the problem
2. Gather the right materials
3. Start with the gentlest suitable method
4. Test first when the surface or fabric is uncertain
5. Clean up, dry the area, and prevent the problem from returning

QUICK INDEX

#	Problem	Category
1	Remove Soap Scum from Shower Doors	Bathroom
2	Freshen a Smelly Bathroom Drain	Bathroom
3	Clean a Dirty Toilet Bowl	Bathroom
4	Brighten Grimy Grout	Bathroom
5	Reduce Mildew on Shower Surfaces	Bathroom
6	Remove Hard-Water Spots from a Faucet	Bathroom
7	Stop a Bathroom Mirror from Looking Streaky	Bathroom
8	Freshen Musty Towels	Laundry
9	Treat Fresh Coffee on a Washable Shirt	Laundry
10	Deal with Grease on Washable Fabric	Laundry
11	Reduce Yellow Underarm Stains	Laundry
12	Remove a Fresh Grass Stain	Laundry
13	Lift Makeup from a Washable Collar	Laundry
14	Clean a Greasy Kitchen Cabinet	Kitchen
15	Refresh a Smelly Microwave	Kitchen
16	Loosen Baked-On Food from a Pan	Kitchen
17	Remove Sticky Residue from a Jar	Kitchen
18	Clean a Cutting Board After Strong-Smelling Foods	Kitchen
19	Deodorize a Refrigerator	Kitchen
20	Clean Grease from a Range Hood Filter	Kitchen
21	Remove Crumbs from a Toaster	Kitchen
22	Freshen a Garbage Can	Kitchen
23	Remove Water Rings from a Washable Table Surface	Home
24	Clean Dust from Fabric Lampshades	Home
25	Freshen a Mattress Surface	Bedroom
26	Remove Pet Hair from a Sofa	Home
27	Clean a Ceiling Fan Safely	Home
28	Remove Scuff Marks from Painted Walls	Home

#	Problem	Category
29	Clean Window Tracks	Home
30	Make Stainless Steel Look Cleaner	Home
31	Clean a Dirty Baseboard	Home
32	Refresh a Musty Closet	Home
33	Clean a Fabric Sofa Spill	Home
34	Remove Candle Wax from a Hard Surface	Home
35	Freshen a Garbage Disposal	Kitchen
36	Clean a Dishwasher Filter	Kitchen
37	Remove Burnt Food from a Glass Cooktop	Kitchen
38	Clean a Washing Machine Door Seal	Laundry
39	Reduce Odor in Running Shoes	Home
40	Clean a Reusable Water Bottle	Kitchen
41	Clean a Grill Grate Safely	Outdoor
42	Refresh Outdoor Plastic Furniture	Outdoor
43	Remove Dirt from a Doormat	Outdoor
44	Clean a Garage Floor Spot	Garage
45	Freshen a Car's Interior	Car
46	Clean a Vacuum Filter	Home
47	Stop a Door from Squeaking	Maintenance
48	Tighten a Loose Cabinet Handle	Maintenance
49	Organize a Home Cleaning Caddy	Organization
50	The 10-Minute Entryway Reset	Organization
51	The 'Before You Throw It Away' Check	Home

01 Remove Soap Scum from Shower Doors

Bathroom • A simple reset for cloudy glass covered with soap residue.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 1 cup warm water + 1 cup white vinegar + 1 teaspoon dish soap

White vinegar • Dish soap • Warm water • Microfiber cloth • Squeegee

HOW TO DO IT

1

Mix equal parts warm water and white vinegar with a small amount of dish soap.

2

Apply to the glass and let it sit for a few minutes.

3

Wipe with a microfiber cloth.

4

Rinse well and dry with a squeegee or clean cloth.

PRO TIP

Dry the glass after showers whenever possible.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Never combine vinegar with bleach or other chlorine products.

02 Freshen a Smelly Bathroom Drain

Bathroom • Help reduce everyday drain odors before they become a bigger nuisance.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: ½ cup baking soda + 1 cup white vinegar

Baking soda • White vinegar • Hot water

HOW TO DO IT

1 Pour about 1/2 cup of baking soda into the drain.

2 Add about 1 cup of white vinegar.

3 Let the mixture work for several minutes.

4 Flush with plenty of hot water.

PRO TIP

Keep hair and debris out of the drain and flush it regularly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not use this method immediately after a commercial drain cleaner. Follow the cleaner's label instructions instead.

03 Clean a Dirty Toilet Bowl

Bathroom • Tackle everyday buildup with a simple cleaning routine.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Toilet bowl cleaner • Toilet brush • Gloves

HOW TO DO IT

1

Apply a toilet cleaner according to its label.

2

Let it sit for the recommended time.

3

Scrub under the rim and around the bowl.

4

Flush and rinse the brush.

PRO TIP

Clean the bowl regularly instead of waiting for heavy buildup.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Never mix toilet cleaner with bleach or another cleaner.

04 Brighten Grimy Grout

Bathroom • Lift surface dirt from tile grout without turning cleaning into an all-day project.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: ½ cup baking soda + 2–3 tablespoons water

Baking soda • Water • Soft brush • Microfiber cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Make a thick paste with baking soda and a little water.

2

Work it into the grout with a soft brush.

3

Leave it for a few minutes.

4

Wipe away residue and rinse with clean water.

PRO TIP

Dry wet areas after cleaning and improve ventilation.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Test on a small area first, especially on delicate or colored grout.

05 Reduce Mildew on Shower Surfaces

Bathroom • Keep small surface mildew spots from taking over the shower.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Bathroom cleaner suitable for mildew • Gloves • Soft brush •
Ventilation

HOW TO DO IT

1

Ventilate the bathroom before cleaning.

2

Apply a suitable mildew cleaner according to its label.

3

Allow the product to sit for the label's recommended time.

4

Gently scrub, rinse, and dry the surface.

PRO TIP

Run the bathroom fan during and after showers.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

For extensive mold, persistent moisture, or hidden growth, contact a qualified professional.

06 Remove Hard-Water Spots from a Faucet

Bathroom • Make dull mineral spots less noticeable and restore a cleaner finish.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: ½ cup white vinegar + ½ cup water

White vinegar • Cloth • Old toothbrush • Water

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Soak a cloth with white vinegar.
- 2 Wrap it around the affected area for a short period.
- 3 Gently brush remaining deposits.
- 4 Rinse thoroughly and dry.

PRO TIP

Wipe faucets dry after use.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not use vinegar on surfaces where the manufacturer says acids are unsuitable.

07 Stop a Bathroom Mirror from Looking Streaky

Bathroom • Get a clearer mirror with less product and less scrubbing.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Glass cleaner • Microfiber cloth

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Use a small amount of glass cleaner.
- 2 Wipe in overlapping strokes from top to bottom.
- 3 Use a dry microfiber cloth for the final pass.

PRO TIP

Less cleaner is usually better for glass.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Keep liquid away from electrical components behind or around the mirror.

08 Freshen Musty Towels

Laundry • Help towels smell fresher and dry more effectively.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Laundry detergent • Washing machine • Dryer or drying rack

HOW TO DO IT

1

Wash towels according to their care label.

2

Avoid overloading the machine.

3

Use the recommended amount of detergent.

4

Dry towels completely before folding or storing.

PRO TIP

Hang towels spread out instead of leaving them in a damp pile.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not add random cleaning chemicals to laundry. Follow the garment and product labels.

09 Treat Fresh Coffee on a Washable Shirt

Laundry • Act quickly to give a fresh coffee spill a better chance of coming out.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: About 1 teaspoon liquid laundry detergent

Cold water • Liquid laundry detergent • Clean cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1 Rinse the back of the stain with cold water.

2 Apply a small amount of liquid detergent.

3 Gently work it into the fabric.

4 Wash according to the garment label.

PRO TIP

Treat stains before putting the item in a hot dryer.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Test stain treatments on a hidden area when fabric care is uncertain.

10 Deal with Grease on Washable Fabric

Laundry • Loosen a fresh grease spot before the next wash.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: About 1 teaspoon dish soap

Dish soap • Laundry detergent • Clean cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Blot excess grease without rubbing it deeper.

2

Apply a small amount of dish soap to the spot.

3

Gently work it into the fabric.

4

Wash according to the care label.

PRO TIP

Act while the stain is fresh.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not use heat until you are sure the stain is gone.

11 Reduce Yellow Underarm Stains

Laundry • Help improve the appearance of old-looking yellow areas on washable white clothing.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Laundry detergent • Oxygen-based stain remover suitable for the fabric
• Water

HOW TO DO IT

1

Check the garment label first.

2

Pre-treat with a suitable oxygen-based stain remover according to its label.

3

Let it work for the recommended time.

4

Wash and inspect before drying.

PRO TIP

Use antiperspirant sparingly and wash garments regularly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not use chlorine bleach unless the garment label permits it.

12 Remove a Fresh Grass Stain

Laundry • Give a fresh grass mark a better chance of coming out in the wash.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Liquid laundry detergent • Cold or cool water

HOW TO DO IT

1

Rinse the stain with cool water.

2

Apply liquid detergent directly to the area.

3

Gently rub or brush according to the fabric.

4

Wash according to the care label.

PRO TIP

Treat the stain before it dries completely.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Avoid heat until the stain is gone.

13 Lift Makeup from a Washable Collar

Laundry • Tackle a common collar stain without aggressive scrubbing.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Liquid laundry detergent • Clean cloth • Cool water

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Blot away excess makeup.
- 2 Apply a small amount of liquid detergent.
- 3 Gently work from the outside toward the center.
- 4 Wash according to the care label.

PRO TIP

Remove makeup before putting clothing in the laundry hamper.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Test first on delicate or dyed fabrics.

14 Clean a Greasy Kitchen Cabinet

Kitchen • Cut through everyday cooking grease without soaking the cabinet.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups warm water + 1 teaspoon dish soap

Warm water • Dish soap • Microfiber cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Add a small amount of dish soap to warm water.

2

Dampen a microfiber cloth and wring it well.

3

Wipe the greasy area.

4

Use a clean damp cloth to remove residue, then dry.

PRO TIP

Wipe cooking splatter before it builds up.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Avoid excessive water on wood or unfinished surfaces.

15 Refresh a Smelly Microwave

Kitchen • Remove everyday food odors and residue from the microwave.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 1 cup water + 3-4 lemon slices

Microwave-safe bowl • Water • Lemon

HOW TO DO IT

1

Add water and a few lemon slices to a microwave-safe bowl.

2

Heat until the water is steaming.

3

Let it sit closed for a few minutes.

4

Wipe the interior with a clean cloth.

PRO TIP

Wipe spills soon after they happen.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Use only microwave-safe containers and follow your appliance instructions.

16 Loosen Baked-On Food from a Pan

Kitchen • Make a stubborn pan easier to clean without aggressive scraping.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 quarts warm water + 1 teaspoon dish soap

Dish soap • Warm water • Non-abrasive sponge

HOW TO DO IT

1 Fill the pan with warm water and a little dish soap.

2 Let it soak.

3 Gently loosen residue with a non-abrasive sponge.

4 Rinse and dry.

PRO TIP

Soak pans soon after cooking when possible.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Follow the cookware manufacturer's cleaning instructions.

17 Remove Sticky Residue from a Jar

Kitchen • Get rid of leftover label adhesive from glass containers.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: About 1 teaspoon cooking oil

Cooking oil • Dish soap • Warm water • Cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Apply a small amount of cooking oil to the adhesive.

2

Let it sit briefly.

3

Rub gently with a cloth.

4

Wash the glass with warm soapy water.

PRO TIP

Peel labels slowly instead of tearing them.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not use oily methods near heat or on surfaces where oil can damage the finish.

18 Clean a Cutting Board After Strong-Smelling

Foods

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 1-2 tablespoons baking soda

Dish soap • Baking soda • Water • Brush or sponge

HOW TO DO IT

1

Wash the board with dish soap and water.

2

Sprinkle a little baking soda over the surface.

3

Gently scrub.

4

Rinse thoroughly and let the board dry completely.

PRO TIP

Allow boards to dry fully between uses.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Use separate boards for raw meat and ready-to-eat foods and follow food-safety guidance.

19 Deodorize a Refrigerator

Kitchen • Reduce everyday refrigerator odors with a simple cleaning reset.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups warm water + 1 teaspoon dish soap; ½ cup baking soda for the odor-absorbing container

Dish soap • Warm water • Baking soda • Clean cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Remove spoiled or expired food.

2

Wipe shelves and surfaces with warm soapy water.

3

Rinse and dry.

4

Place an open container of baking soda inside to help absorb odors.

PRO TIP

Check leftovers regularly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Never use cleaners directly on food. Follow appliance instructions.

20 Clean Grease from a Range Hood Filter

Kitchen • Reduce greasy buildup on a washable filter.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 1 gallon hot water + 1-2 tablespoons dish soap

Dish soap • Hot water • Soft brush or sponge

HOW TO DO IT

1

Check whether the filter is washable.

2

Soak it in hot soapy water.

3

Gently scrub away softened grease.

4

Rinse and dry completely before reinstalling.

PRO TIP

Clean the filter on the schedule recommended by the manufacturer.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not soak or wash filters that are not designed to be washed.

21 Remove Crumbs from a Toaster

Kitchen • Clean loose crumbs from a toaster safely.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Dry cloth • Small soft brush

HOW TO DO IT

1

Unplug the toaster and let it cool completely.

2

Remove the crumb tray if the model has one.

3

Empty and clean the tray.

4

Turn the toaster as directed by the manufacturer and remove loose crumbs.

PRO TIP

Empty the crumb tray regularly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Never clean a plugged-in toaster or put it in water.

22 Freshen a Garbage Can

Kitchen • Reduce lingering odors from the kitchen trash can.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 1 gallon warm water + 1 tablespoon dish soap; ¼ cup baking soda

Dish soap • Warm water • Baking soda • Brush or cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Empty the can.

2

Wash the inside with warm soapy water.

3

Rinse and dry completely.

4

Sprinkle a small amount of baking soda in the bottom before adding a new liner.

PRO TIP

Tie up wet or strongly scented waste promptly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not mix cleaners together.

23 Remove Water Rings from a Washable Table

Surface

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups water + 1 teaspoon mild dish soap
Soft cloth • Mild dish soap • Water

HOW TO DO IT

1

Wipe the area with a slightly damp cloth and mild soapy water.

2

Dry immediately.

3

If the mark remains, check the furniture manufacturer's care instructions before trying anything stronger.

PRO TIP

Use coasters and wipe spills promptly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Different finishes react differently. Test any treatment in a hidden spot first.

24 Clean Dust from Fabric Lampshades

Home • Remove loose dust without soaking the shade.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Vacuum with brush attachment or soft brush • Dry microfiber cloth

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Turn the lamp off and let it cool.
- 2 Use a soft brush or vacuum brush attachment.
- 3 Work gently from top to bottom.
- 4 Finish with a dry microfiber cloth if appropriate.

PRO TIP

Dust shades regularly so buildup does not become embedded.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Keep liquid away from electrical components.

25 Freshen a Mattress Surface

Bedroom • Refresh the surface of a mattress between deeper cleanings.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: About ½ cup baking soda for a standard mattress surface

Baking soda • Vacuum

HOW TO DO IT

1

Strip the bed and wash the linens.

2

Sprinkle a light layer of baking soda over the mattress surface.

3

Let it sit for a while in a dry, ventilated room.

4

Vacuum thoroughly using a clean upholstery attachment.

PRO TIP

Use a washable mattress protector.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not saturate a mattress. For bodily-fluid contamination or persistent odor, follow professional cleaning guidance.

26 Remove Pet Hair from a Sofa

Home • Collect loose pet hair from upholstery with less effort.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Vacuum • Rubber glove or upholstery tool

HOW TO DO IT

1

Vacuum the sofa using an upholstery attachment.

2

For stubborn hair, lightly run a clean rubber glove over the fabric.

3

Vacuum the loosened hair.

4

Check the upholstery care label before using any wet method.

PRO TIP

Brush pets regularly and vacuum high-traffic areas.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not use wet methods on fabrics that are not water-safe.

27 Clean a Ceiling Fan Safely

Home • Remove dust from fan blades without making a bigger mess.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Step stool rated for the job • Old pillowcase or microfiber cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Turn the fan off and wait until the blades stop.

2

Use a stable step stool.

3

Slide a pillowcase over each blade and gently pull the dust inward.

4

Finish with a microfiber cloth if needed.

PRO TIP

Dust fan blades regularly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Never stand on furniture or clean a moving fan.

28 Remove Scuff Marks from Painted Walls

Home • Reduce light shoe and furniture marks on washable painted walls.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups water + 1 teaspoon mild dish soap

Damp microfiber cloth • Mild dish soap • Water

HOW TO DO IT

1 Mix a small amount of dish soap with water.

2 Dampen a microfiber cloth and wring it well.

3 Gently wipe the mark.

4 Dry the area.

PRO TIP

Use furniture pads and avoid dragging items against walls.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Test first on a hidden area because some paint finishes are not washable.

29 Clean Window Tracks

Home • Remove the dirt that collects where the window actually slides.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups warm water + 1 teaspoon mild dish soap

Vacuum • Old toothbrush • Warm soapy water • Cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Vacuum loose debris from the track.

2

Use an old toothbrush to loosen packed dirt.

3

Wipe with a lightly damp soapy cloth.

4

Dry the track.

PRO TIP

Clean tracks a few times each year.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Keep excess water away from wood and drainage openings.

30 Make Stainless Steel Look Cleaner

Home • Reduce fingerprints and smudges on stainless-steel surfaces.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups warm water + ½ teaspoon dish soap

Microfiber cloth • Warm water • A small amount of dish soap

HOW TO DO IT

1

Wipe with a lightly damp microfiber cloth.

2

For greasy marks, use a tiny amount of dish soap.

3

Wipe again with clean water.

4

Dry with the grain using a clean cloth.

PRO TIP

Wipe spills and fingerprints before they build up.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Avoid abrasive pads and check the appliance manufacturer's care instructions.

31 Clean a Dirty Baseboard

Home • Bring dusty, neglected baseboards back to a cleaner appearance.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups warm water + 1 teaspoon mild dish soap

Vacuum brush • Warm water • Mild dish soap • Microfiber cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Vacuum loose dust first.

2

Dampen a microfiber cloth with mild soapy water.

3

Wipe the baseboard in sections.

4

Dry as you go.

PRO TIP

Vacuum baseboards during regular floor cleaning.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not saturate painted wood or MDF.

32 Refresh a Musty Closet

Home • Improve the smell and airflow of a stale closet.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: ½ cup baking soda in an open container

Baking soda • Clean cloth • Ventilation

HOW TO DO IT

1

Remove damp or musty items.

2

Clean visible dust.

3

Leave the door open when practical to improve airflow.

4

Place an open container of baking soda in the closet to absorb odors.

PRO TIP

Never store clothing while it is damp.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Persistent musty smells can indicate moisture or mold. Address the moisture source.

33 Clean a Fabric Sofa Spill

Home • Handle a fresh spill before it has time to set.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Clean white cloths • Water • Upholstery cleaner approved for the fabric

HOW TO DO IT

1

Blot the spill gently—do not rub.

2

Check the upholstery care label.

3

Use an approved cleaner according to its instructions.

4

Blot excess moisture and allow the area to dry fully.

PRO TIP

Deal with spills quickly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Always test a cleaner in a hidden area first.

34 Remove Candle Wax from a Hard Surface

Home • Lift cooled candle wax without scratching the surface.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ice pack or ice wrapped in cloth • Plastic scraper • Soft cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Let the wax cool completely.

2

Use an ice pack briefly to make the wax more brittle.

3

Gently lift the wax with a plastic scraper.

4

Wipe away remaining residue according to the surface manufacturer's instructions.

PRO TIP

Use candle holders or trays to catch drips.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not use sharp metal tools on delicate finishes.

35 Freshen a Garbage Disposal

Kitchen • Reduce everyday odors from a disposal unit.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Citrus peels • Cold water

HOW TO DO IT

1

Turn on cold water.

2

Run the disposal according to the manufacturer's instructions.

3

Add a few small citrus peels if the manufacturer permits.

4

Continue running cold water briefly afterward.

PRO TIP

Run cold water while using the disposal and avoid putting inappropriate foods down it.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Never put your hand into the disposal. Follow the appliance manual.

36 Clean a Dishwasher Filter

Kitchen • Help your dishwasher drain and clean more effectively by checking its filter.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Dish soap • Soft brush • Warm water

HOW TO DO IT

1

Turn off the dishwasher.

2

Locate and remove the filter according to the manual.

3

Rinse it under warm water and gently brush away debris.

4

Reinstall it securely.

PRO TIP

Check the filter regularly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Filter locations and removal methods vary by model. Use the manual.

37 Remove Burnt Food from a Glass Cooktop

Kitchen • Loosen stuck-on residue while reducing the risk of scratches.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Cooktop scraper approved for glass • Cooktop cleaner • Microfiber cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Let the cooktop cool completely.

2

Use a cooktop scraper designed for glass according to its instructions.

3

Apply approved cooktop cleaner.

4

Wipe with a microfiber cloth.

PRO TIP

Wipe spills after the surface cools.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not use abrasive powders or tools that can scratch the cooktop.

38 Clean a Washing Machine Door Seal

Laundry • Remove lint and residue that can collect around the rubber seal.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups warm water + 1 teaspoon mild dish soap

Microfiber cloth • Warm soapy water • Soft toothbrush

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Open the door and inspect the seal folds.
- 2 Remove lint and debris.
- 3 Wipe with warm soapy water.
- 4 Dry the seal and leave the door ajar after use.

PRO TIP

Leave the door open between washes when safe and practical.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Follow your washing machine manufacturer's cleaning instructions.

39 Reduce Odor in Running Shoes

Home • Freshen washable or odor-prone shoes between uses.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 1-2 tablespoons baking soda per shoe

Baking soda • Paper towels

HOW TO DO IT

1

Make sure the shoes are dry.

2

Place a small amount of baking soda inside each shoe.

3

Leave overnight.

4

Shake or vacuum out the powder before wearing.

PRO TIP

Alternate shoes and let each pair dry fully.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Check the shoe manufacturer's care instructions before using powders or washing.

40 Clean a Reusable Water Bottle

Kitchen • Remove residue and odors from a reusable bottle.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Dish soap • Bottle brush • Warm water

HOW TO DO IT

1

Disassemble the lid and removable parts.

2

Wash every part with warm soapy water.

3

Use a bottle brush for the interior.

4

Rinse thoroughly and allow all parts to dry completely.

PRO TIP

Clean bottles regularly, especially after sweet drinks.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Follow the bottle manufacturer's instructions for dishwasher use.

41 Clean a Grill Grate Safely

Outdoor • Remove food residue from a cooled grill grate.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Grill brush approved for the grate • Dish soap if permitted • Warm water

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Turn off the grill and let it cool completely.
- 2 Remove loose residue with an appropriate grill brush.
- 3 Wash the grate if the manufacturer permits.
- 4 Rinse and dry thoroughly before the next use.

PRO TIP

Clean grates regularly after cooking.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Inspect the grate and brush for damage before use.

42 Refresh Outdoor Plastic Furniture

Outdoor • Remove everyday dirt from washable outdoor furniture.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 1 gallon warm water + 1 tablespoon dish soap

Dish soap • Warm water • Soft brush • Hose or cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Brush off loose dirt.

2

Wash with warm soapy water.

3

Gently scrub stubborn areas.

4

Rinse and let the furniture dry.

PRO TIP

Clean furniture before storing it for long periods.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Check the manufacturer's care instructions.

43 Remove Dirt from a Doormat

Outdoor • Get more life out of a washable doormat by removing trapped dirt.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Vacuum or brush • Mild soap • Water

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Shake or vacuum loose dirt.
- 2 Check the care label.
- 3 Wash using an approved method.
- 4 Dry completely before placing it back.

PRO TIP

Vacuum mats regularly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not wet a mat that is not designed to be washed.

44 Clean a Garage Floor Spot

Garage • Improve the appearance of a small oil or grime spot without tackling the entire garage.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: 2 cups warm water + 1 tablespoon dish soap

Absorbent material suitable for oil spills • Dish soap • Warm water • Stiff brush

HOW TO DO IT

1

Blot or absorb fresh oil according to the product directions.

2

Remove the absorbent material safely.

3

Apply a small amount of dish soap and warm water.

4

Scrub the spot and rinse if the surface allows.

PRO TIP

Deal with spills quickly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

For large spills or hazardous substances, use appropriate local disposal and professional guidance.

45 Freshen a Car's Interior

Car • Reduce everyday dust and stale odors inside the vehicle.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Vacuum • Microfiber cloth • Interior cleaner approved for the surface

HOW TO DO IT

1

Remove trash and loose items.

2

Vacuum seats, mats and floor areas.

3

Wipe hard surfaces with an approved interior cleaner.

4

Air out the vehicle when conditions allow.

PRO TIP

Remove food and damp items promptly.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Never apply cleaners to pedals, steering controls, or screens unless the vehicle manufacturer permits it.

46 Clean a Vacuum Filter

Home • Help maintain vacuum performance by checking the filter.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Vacuum manual • Replacement or washable filter as specified

HOW TO DO IT

- 1 Turn off and unplug the vacuum.
- 2 Locate the filter according to the manual.
- 3 Clean or replace it as the manufacturer specifies.
- 4 Reinstall it securely before use.

PRO TIP

Check filters on the schedule recommended for your model.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not wash a filter unless it is specifically designed to be washable.

47 Stop a Door from Squeaking

Maintenance • Reduce a common squeak with a simple hinge check.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Suggested amount: A few drops of suitable hinge lubricant

Appropriate hinge lubricant • Cloth

HOW TO DO IT

1

Open and close the door to identify the noisy hinge.

2

Place a small amount of suitable lubricant on the hinge.

3

Move the door several times.

4

Wipe away excess lubricant.

PRO TIP

Check loose hinge screws while the door is open.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Use a lubricant compatible with the hinge and finish; do not spray blindly near painted surfaces.

48 Tighten a Loose Cabinet Handle

Maintenance • Fix a wobbly cabinet handle with a basic check.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Screwdriver

HOW TO DO IT

1

Open the cabinet.

2

Locate the handle screws.

3

Hold the handle steady.

4

Tighten the screws gently without overtightening.

PRO TIP

Check handles periodically.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Use the correct screwdriver and stop if the hardware is damaged.

49 Organize a Home Cleaning Caddy

Organization • Create a grab-and-go cleaning kit so small jobs take less time to start.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Small caddy or basket • Microfiber cloths • Basic cleaners approved for your surfaces

HOW TO DO IT

1

Choose a small set of frequently used supplies.

2

Keep cloths and tools together.

3

Label products if needed.

4

Store the caddy in a safe, dry place away from children and pets.

PRO TIP

Restock the caddy once a week.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Never transfer chemicals into unlabeled containers and keep products in their original containers when possible.

50 The 10-Minute Entryway Reset

Organization • Make the entrance look cleaner by focusing on the areas visitors notice first.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Trash bag • Basket • Cloth • Vacuum

HOW TO DO IT

1

Remove obvious trash.

2

Put misplaced items into a basket.

3

Wipe the main surfaces.

4

Vacuum or sweep the floor.

PRO TIP

Keep a small basket near the entrance for items that need to be put away.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not block exits or walkways with storage baskets.

51 The 'Before You Throw It Away' Check

Home • Create a simple pause before replacing an item that looks dirty or worn.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Clean cloth • Mild cleaner appropriate for the material • Good lighting

HOW TO DO IT

1

Identify exactly what is wrong: dirt, stain, odor, loose hardware, or actual damage.

2

Check the item's care instructions.

3

Try the gentlest appropriate cleaning or adjustment first.

4

If the problem is structural, electrical, or unsafe, stop and seek professional help.

PRO TIP

Give repairable items a second look before replacing them.

SAFETY / CARE NOTE

Do not attempt repairs involving gas, mains electricity, structural damage, or other hazards without qualified help.

THE HOME RESCUE CHECKLIST

Keep this final checklist somewhere easy to find. The goal is not to clean everything every day—it is to catch

WHEN		CHECK
Weekly	✓	Check high-traffic floors and entryways
Weekly	✓	Wipe kitchen surfaces and cabinet fronts
Weekly	✓	Check bathroom buildup and odors
Weekly	✓	Empty or clean trash containers
Monthly	✓	Check appliance filters and washable parts
Monthly	✓	Clean window tracks and neglected corners
Monthly	✓	Inspect under sinks for moisture
Seasonally	✓	Check outdoor furniture and entry areas
Seasonally	✓	Review home cleaning supplies and discard damaged/expired items
Anytime	✓	Deal with spills and stains before heat sets them